The importance on operations strategies in improving business performance is enormous, as the implementation of well-thought operations strategies can immensely improve business performance. Operations strategies refers to the strategies put in place by an operations manager to improve the entire operations process. 3 businesses who have used operations strategies that have vastly had success with the operations strategies of quality management, leading-edge technology and new product/service design and development is Lego, Rio Tinto and Nestle Oceania respectively.

Quality management refers to the operations manager continuously improving the quality of products, in an attempt to become defect free. The three quality management strategies include quality control, quality assurance and Total Quality Management (TQM). Quality control refers to a numerous number of checks throughout the production process. Quality assurance refers to the use of a documented system in order to meet consumer quality standards. TQM refers to continuous improvement in all aspects of the business. A company that has successfully implemented the strategies of quality control and quality assurance is Lego, and can be judged on the criteria of:

- quality: a state of dependability

- improved quality: a state of being defect-free

- improved dependability: the uniformity, consistency and reliability of the product.

Lego is a large, Danish toy manufacturer. Each Lego set is rigorously tested through the use of a documented system (ISO 9001) to ensure each and every toy brick they produce meets customer, company and international standards. As well as this, their machinery linked to the uniformity of reliability of their products involves an injection moulding system (0.0001mm), producing a defect rate of only 18 blocks per million (0.0002%). Because Lego's target market involves children, they have gone to the length of ensuring infant safety by using drop, torque, bite and compression tests randomly, with each block being chosen at random and tested 8 times. Lego prides themselves on the quality of their products, and this is shown through only 1 product recall in the past decade. ~~[illegible]~~ From 2014-2015, Lego saw a 25% increase in their revenue to 5.8 billion, purely based on their consumers trust in quality. Furthermore, when judged on the performance objectives of improved quality and dependability, the

strategy of quality management has improved business performance drastically.

Leading edge technology refers to technology that is in the forefront of knowledge, the most up-to-date, highest quality and cost machinery in the world at a given point in time. A business that has improved business performance drastically by their use of leading edge technology is Rio Tinto, and can be judged on the criteria of:
- reduced ~~improved~~ cost minimisation of expenses to increase profit.
- improved speed/how quickly it takes for the product to be made.

Rio Tinto is a large, multinational mining company. In the Pilbara Mines, Rio Tinto implemented the use of driverless trucks in an attempt to improve their cost and speed. Through their use of this leading edge technology, their cost per tonne of iron ore reduced by 15%. Part of the driverless trucks involved a built-in software system that put the truck on the fastest possible route, overall reducing truck trip time by 3 minutes per trip, increasing speed and efficiency ~~increase~~. Overall, this strategy saved the company over 500 labour hours, as the trucks operate 23 hours a day, 365 days a week. As a result of this

strategy. Rio Tinto increased their iron ore output rate by 1.6%, whilst also increasing revenues by 6%. Therefore, when judged on the criteria of improved cost and improved speed, the strategy of leading-edge technology through the use of driverless trucks was extremely successful in achieving improved business performance for Rio Tinto.

New product/service design and development refers to coming up with innovative ways to design a product based on changing consumer tastes and preferences, but also creating a new product that satisfies business objectives. This is clearly seen through Nestle Oceania's development and design of a new, resilient oat, and can be judged on the criteria of:

- reducing costs: minimisation of expenses to maximise profit
- improving speed: how quickly it takes for the product to be made, improved quality: state of being defect free

Nestle Oceania is a large food manufacturer, most well-known for their brand Uncle Tobys. Nestle Oceania partnered with the South Australian Research and Development Institute to develop a new, innovative oat. In doing this, they offered the oat to farmers in a 100 km radius of their Wahgunyah Operations centre to test and try it out. In 2017, of the 26,649 oats that

were produced over 11,000 of these came from the farmers who were first offered it, reducing cartage costs inherently and improving transport speeds to distribution centres as well. In doing this, they reduced total costs that year by 15%, and they used 07% less water to grow the resilient oat, reducing gluten and increasing quality. Along with this, in relation to international standards of quality, the new oat received a higher quality grading ever than any other product in previous years of Nestle Oceania. Furthermore, when judged on the criteria of reducing costs, improving speed, and improving quality, the new development of Nestle Oceania's resilient oat has improved business performance enormously.

In conclusion, the operations strategies of quality management, leading edge technology, and new product design and development have all improved business performance instantly for Lego, Rio Tinto, and Nestle Oceania respectively.

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Your introduction is a clear roadmap for the marker. Your Lego paragraph has solid detail on quality control and assurance and you establish criteria and make a sound judgement. Rio Tinto and Nestle oats was also very well done.